ACT

Encyclopaedia Britannica (1771)

Historical source

Entry ID: `entry-act-563`
Volume ID: 191253801
Character Count: 5893

Extracted Text

ACT, in general, denotes the exertion of powers and differs from power, as the result from the caife.

Acrs, in logics is particularly underhood of an operation of the human mind. Thus to difern and examine, are acts of the understanding; to judge and at firm, are due of the will. There are voluntary and fpoantous acts, the former are produced by the o- peration of the foul, the latter without its priority or participation.

Acr, in the univerities, figuifies a hefixa maintained in public by a candidate for a degree of to those the capacity and proficiency of a fluid. The candidates for a degree of bachelor and matter of arts are to hold philosophical facts; and that for bachelor of divists; theological Ads, etc. At Oxford, the time we make or doctors complete their degrees in alo called the \(\ell\), which is bad with great formally. At Cam bridge, they call the _commencement_.

Art of Faith, Auto da Fe., in the Romih church is a inform day hall by the inputition, for the punihmatic of herties, and the abolition of the moment ac- ready. They usually contre the data to fall on some great fellows, that the execution may pals with the more are said regards to fault it is why on a Sunday." The Auto da Fe may be called the lail ads of the important legacy, it is a kind of goal-delivery, as painted as art as a computer number of princes in the imajdition are convicted of herefly, either by their own voluntary, or extendable condition, or on the very dense of certain vitamines. The precects is thus in the morning they are brought into a great hall, where they have certain habits put on, which they were over in the position. The procedure is led up by domic mica frians; after which come the pretents, fome with fan-bentines, and home without according to the ma-ture of their crimes being all in black costs without fleece, and have disclosed, with a wax made in their hands. Those are followed by the patients who have narrowly cleped being burnt, who over their black costs have flames painted with their points turned downwards, _Fong credits_. Next came the negative, and relapted, who are to be burnt, having flames on their habitat pointing upwards. After their coreem fish so profils doethins contrary to the faith of Rome, who, bo-fides flame pointing upwards, have their picture painted on their breasts, with dogs, ferpets, and devils, all Vou. I. Part I.

open-noouthed, about it. Each prisoner is attended with a familiar of the imajdition; and thode to be burnt have also a feilini on each hand, who are continually providing them to abquire. After the proninces, occurs a crop of families on horseback; and after them the imajditions, and other officers of the court, on under a full, the imajdition geared in on a whole barfe, led by two men with black hats and green hat-bands. A feathal is erected in the _Perrier of Faith_, though we too no three cardinal people; at one end of which are the prisoners, at the other the imajditions. After fieron made up of examination of the imajdition, and involves agored hervics, a pritti discuss a delle near the middle of the featlold, and having taken these humaines of the protests, across the final features of those whoare not be yet to death; and delivers them to the facular arm, carefully beechning at the famine time the facular power not to touch their block, or put their lives in danger. The policions being thus in the hands of the civil magiltrate, are perfectly loaded with chains, and carried forth the facular goal, and then thereor in an hour and two brought before the civil judges, who, after asking in what religion they intend to do, provinsome fortement, on fashion as dearney

they are to the common on the bottom of Rome, that they fhall be furll llarged, and then burnt to others; on faith as the in any other fairly, that they be burned alive. Both are immediately credited to the Ribbers, the place of execution; where there are as many flakes (top up at there are prisoners to be burnt) with a quantity of dry first a boat them. The flakes of the profiled, that is, fuch as perifin in their ferry, you about four yraish, having a small band towards the top for a police to be sent on. The negative and relapted being furft flamgled and burnt, the profil mounten their flakes by a hotel, and the fields, after fewer reported ex-torations to be reconciled to the church, part with them, taking them they have been to the need, who is finding at their elbow to receive their faith, and carry them with him into the flames of bell. On this a great throat is ruled; and the cry is, Let the dogs _hard beide_; which is also by blending flaming forces failened to long poles against their faces, till their faces are burnt to a cool, which is incomposed with the loudech schammans of my. Attak, fire is fed to the furze at the bottom of the lake; over which the profiled are claimed to high, that the top of the flame leidum reaches higher than the fact they (is on; its that they rather fearn rouled than burnt. There cannot be a more lumomable fipchelle; the fathers continually cool, with they are able, _Billficiardia Year anno de Dies,_ "Pity for the love of God!" yet it is held by all faces, and ages with transports of jy and satisfaction. Accr, in dramatic poetry, figuesia a certain divi- tion, or part, of a play, delayed to give fine reripe both to the actions and portions. The Romanes were still who divided their theatrical pieces into acts as for no foch division appear in the works of the fruit dramatic poster. Their piece indeed conflict of rec- parts or divisions, which they called _yristalis, epi- taglis, catellefs_ and _catellefsly,_ but their divisions were the markets by any real interruption on the theatre. No- does Arildend mention any thing of acts in his Art of Poetry. But, in the time of Horace, all regular and finished pieces were divided into five acts.

Source record

- **Dataset:** `NationalLibraryOfScotland/encyclopaedia_britannica_illustrated`
- **Dataset Revision:** `309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443`
- **Page ID:** `britannica:309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443:train:563`
  Filename: `page-0563-d12ce09577cd.jpg`
  Row Index: 563
  SHA256: `d12ce09577cd595f...`

Acroteleutic Act.

ACROTELEUTIC, among eccleſiaſtic writers, an appellation given to any thing added to the end of a pſalm; as the Gloria Patri, or Doxology.

ACROTERIA, in architecture, ſmall pedeſtals, uſually without baſes, anciently placed at the middle or two extremes of pediments or frontiſpieces, ſerving to ſupport the ſtatues, &c. It alſo ſignifies the figures placed as ornaments on the tops of churches, and the ſharp pinnacles that ſtand in ranges about flat buildings with rails and balluſters.

Among ancient phyſicians, it ſignified the larger extremities of the body, as the head, hands, and feet. It has alſo been uſed for the tips of the fingers, and ſometimes for the eminences or proceſſes of bones

ACROTHYMION, from ακρον, *extreme*, and θυμος, *thyme*. A ſort of wart deſcribed by Celſus as hard, rough, with a narrow baſis and broad top; the top is of the colour of thyme, it eaſily ſplits and bleeds. This tumour is alſo called *thymus*.

ACT, in general, denotes the exertion of power; and differs from power, as the effect from the cauſe.

Act, in logic, is particularly underſtood of an operation of the human mind. Thus to diſcern and examine, are acts of the underſtanding; to judge and affirm, are acts of the will. There are voluntary and ſpontaneous acts; the former are produced by the operation of the ſoul, the latter without its privity or participation.

Act, in the univerſities, ſignifies a theſis maintained in public by a candidate for a degree; or to ſhow the capacity and proficiency of a ſtudent. The candidates for a degree of bachelor and maſter of arts are to hold philoſophical Acts; and thoſe for bachelor of divinity, theological Acts, &c. At Oxford, the time when maſters or doctors complete their degrees is alſo called the *act*; which is held with great ſolemnity. At Cambridge, they call it the *commencement*.

Act of Faith, *Auto da Fe*, in the Romiſh church is a ſolemn day held by the inquiſition, for the puniſhment of heretics, and the abſolution of the innocent accuſed*. They uſually contrive the *Auto* to fall on ſome great feſtival, that the execution may paſs with the more awe and regard; at leaſt it is always on a Sunday.

*See Inquiſition.

The Auto da Fe may be called the laſt act of the inquiſitorial tragedy; it is a kind of goal-delivery, appointed as oft as a competent number of priſoners in the inquiſition are convicted of hereſy, either by their own voluntary, or extorted confeſſion, or on the evidence of certain witneſſes. The proceſs is thus: in the morning they are brought into a great hall, where they have certain habits put on, which they are to wear in the proceſſion. The proceſſion is led up by dominican friars; after which come the penitents, ſome with ſan-benitoes, and ſome without, according to the nature of their crimes; being all in black coats without ſleeves, and bare-footed, with a wax candle in their hands. Theſe are followed by the penitents who have narrowly eſcaped being burnt, who over their black coats have flames painted with their points turned downwards, *Fuego revolto*. Next come the negative, and relapſed, who are to be burnt, having flames on their habits pointing upwards. After theſe come ſuch as profeſs doctrines contrary to the faith of Rome, who, beſides flames pointing upwards, have their picture painted on their breaſts, with dogs, ſerpents, and devils, all open-mouthed, about it. Each priſoner is attended with a familiar of the inquiſition; and thoſe to be burnt have alſo a Jeſuit on each hand, who are continually preaching to them to abjure. After the priſoners, comes a troop of familiars on horſeback; and after them the inquiſitors, and other officers of the court, on mules; laſt of all, the inquiſitor-general on a white horſe, led by two men with black hats and green hat-bands. A ſcaffold is erected in the *Terriero de Paio*, big enough for two or three thouſand people; at one end of which are the priſoners, at the other the inquiſitors. After a ſermon made up of encomiums of the inquiſition, and invectives againſt heretics, a prieſt aſcends a deſk near the middle of the ſcaffold, and having taken the abjuration of the penitents, recites the final ſentence of thoſe who are to be put to death; and delivers them to the ſecular arm, earneſtly beſeeching at the ſame time the ſecular power not to touch their blood, or put their lives in danger. The priſoners being thus in the hands of the civil magiſtrate, are preſently loaded with chains, and carried firſt to the ſecular goal, and from thence in an hour or two brought before the civil judge; who, after aſking in what religion they intend to die, pronounces ſentence, on ſuch as declare they die in the communion of the church of Rome, that they ſhall be firſt ſtrangled, and then burnt to aſhes; on ſuch as die in any other faith, that they be burnt alive. Both are immediately carried to the Ribera, the place of execution; where there are as many ſtakes ſet up as there are priſoners to be burnt, with a quantity of dry furze about them. The ſtakes of the profeſſed, that is, ſuch as perſiſt in their hereſy, are about four yards high, having a ſmall board towards the top for the priſoner to be ſeated on. The negative and relapſed being firſt ſtrangled and burnt, the profeſſed mount their ſtakes by a ladder; and the Jeſuits, after ſeveral repeated exhortations to be reconciled to the church, part with them, telling them they leave them to the devil, who is ſtanding at their elbow to receive their ſouls, and carry them with him into the flames of hell. On this a great ſhout is raiſed; and the cry is, Let the dogs *beards be made*; which is done by thruſting flaming furzes faſtened to long poles againſt their faces, till their faces are burnt to a coal, which is accompanied with the loudeſt acclamations of joy. At laſt, fire is ſet to the furze at the bottom of the ſtake, over which the profeſſed are chained ſo high, that the top of the flame ſeldom reaches higher than the ſeat they ſit on; ſo that they rather ſeem roaſted than burnt. There cannot be a more lamentable ſpectacle; the ſufferers continually cry out, while they are able, *Miſericordia per amor de Dios*, "Pity for the love of God!" yet it is beheld by all ſexes, and ages, with tranſports of joy and ſatisfaction.

Act, in dramatic poetry, ſignifies a certain diviſion, or part, of a play, deſigned to give ſome reſpite both to the actors and ſpectators. The Romans were the firſt who divided their theatrical pieces into acts; for no ſuch diviſions appear in the works of the firſt dramatic poets. Their pieces indeed conſiſted of ſeveral parts or diviſions, which they called *protaſis*, *epitaſis*, *cataſtaſis*, and *cataſtrophe*; but theſe diviſions were not marked by any real interruptions on the theatre. Nor does Ariſtotle mention any thing of acts in his Art of Poetry. But, in the time of Horace, all regular and finiſhed pieces were divided into five acts.

Figure 1: *
Source scan: page-0563-d12ce09577cd.jpg